

Day 10 Task — Security Policies

A cybersecurity policy is a set of rules and guidelines established by an organization to protect its computers, networks, applications, and confidential information from security threats. It defines how employees should use organizational resources, manage passwords, protect devices, communicate through email, and report security incidents.

A well-defined security policy helps reduce security risks, prevent unauthorized access, and establish clear responsibilities for employees.

2. Objective

The main objective is to develop a basic cybersecurity policy for a small organization and understand how organizational security controls help protect information and technology resources.

Basic Cybersecurity Policy for a Small Organization

Password Security Policy

Employees must create strong and unique passwords for their accounts. Passwords must not be shared with colleagues or stored in insecure locations. Multi-factor authentication (MFA) should be enabled wherever possible, especially for email, administrator accounts, and systems containing sensitive information.

If an employee suspects that a password has been compromised, it must be changed promptly and reported to the appropriate IT personnel.

3.2 Device Security Policy

All computers, laptops, and mobile devices used for organizational work must be protected against unauthorized access. Employees should lock their devices when leaving their workstations and install approved security updates regularly.

Antivirus or endpoint protection software should be used where appropriate. Lost or stolen devices must be reported immediately so that the organization can take steps to protect its information.

3.3 Email and Internet Usage Policy

Employees must use organizational email and internet resources responsibly. Suspicious emails, unexpected attachments, and unknown links should be treated cautiously.

Confidential organizational information must not be sent to unauthorized recipients. Employees should verify unusual requests for sensitive information or financial transactions through a trusted communication channel.

3.4 Data Protection Policy

Confidential information must be accessible only to authorized individuals. Employees should store organizational data in approved locations and avoid transferring sensitive files through unauthorized applications or personal accounts.

Important information should be backed up regularly, and access permissions should be reviewed periodically. Data must be shared only when there is a legitimate business requirement.

3.5 Access Control Policy

Every employee should receive access only to the systems and information required for their job responsibilities. Administrator privileges should be restricted to authorized personnel.

When an employee leaves the organization or changes roles, their access permissions must be reviewed and updated promptly. Shared accounts should be avoided where individual accounts can be provided.

3.6 Incident Reporting Policy

Employees must report suspected security incidents, including phishing emails, malware infections, unauthorized account access, lost devices, and accidental disclosure of confidential information.

Reports should be sent to the designated IT or security team as soon as possible. Employees should preserve relevant evidence and avoid attempting unapproved actions that could interfere with the investigation.

The organization should document incidents, investigate their causes, and implement corrective measures to prevent similar incidents in the future.

4. Employee Responsibilities

Employees play an important role in maintaining organizational cybersecurity. They are expected to follow established security policies, participate in security awareness training, protect their login credentials, use devices responsibly, and report suspicious activity.

Managers and IT personnel should communicate security requirements clearly, review access permissions, maintain appropriate security controls, and ensure that employees understand the procedures to follow during an incident.

5. Importance of Cybersecurity Policies

Cybersecurity policies provide a consistent approach to protecting organizational resources. They help prevent unauthorized access, reduce human error, protect confidential information, clarify employee responsibilities, and improve incident response.

For small organizations, clear and practical policies are particularly valuable because they establish essential security practices without requiring unnecessarily complicated procedures.

A basic cybersecurity policy is essential for protecting the information, devices, and digital resources of a small organization. Policies covering passwords, device security, email usage, data protection, access control, and incident reporting help establish a safer working environment.

Regular policy reviews, employee training, and consistent implementation of security controls can strengthen an organization's overall security posture and reduce the likelihood and impact of cyberattacks.